# Final report and assessment

December 2026 in-person class · Lesson 8

Write by hand during the final 45 minutes of Lesson 8 on the paper provided. Submit your report in class. You may consult course materials and notes. No internet access is required.

## Task

Choose one question about past environments or history that can be investigated with tree rings. Develop a research plan or review published studies or cases. Address all four prompts.

1. What do you want to find out? Specify the place, period and material.

2. How would the rings be observed and dated? Explain how they provide evidence.

3. What alternative explanation or comparison material should be considered?

4. What can you conclude or reasonably expect? What are the limits, and what should be checked next?

There is no minimum page or reference count, and figures are optional. Identify any sources you use as clearly as you can. In a research plan, describe expected observations as expectations. In a review, explain how the studies or cases compare.

## Scope for the 45-minute report

Choose one course case or one specific subject of your own. Address one question in about four paragraphs: question and scope; tree-ring evidence and method; one alternative explanation and comparison; conclusion, limits and next check. Choose either a proposal or a case review; you do not need to do both.

Allow roughly five minutes to plan, 30 to write and ten to check, then submit in class. No new experiment, measurement or literature search is required. About 250–400 English words is a guide, not a minimum or a grading criterion. A shorter report can satisfy the criteria if the evidence and reasoning are sufficient. Use a short title stating your question in the task field of the supplied paper. A course reference such as “Lesson 5, slide 7” is sufficient.

## Assessment

The report alone determines the course grade. Classroom activities and participation are ungraded.

| Criterion | What earns 20 points |
|---|---|
| Question and scope | A specific question and a clear place, period and material. |
| Materials and method | A reason for choosing the material and an explanation of dating and interpretation. |
| Comparison and reasoning | A comparison or alternative explanation and a clear connection from evidence to claim. |

| Criterion | What earns 20 points |
| --- | --- |
| Evidence and attribution | Evidence can be identified. Explain the purpose of any figure or table you use. |
| Conclusion, limits and next steps | A conclusion within the evidence, with uncertainty and a concrete follow-up. |

Each criterion is worth 20 points, for a total of 100. Scores of 20, 15, 10 or 5 reflect how fully the criterion is met. A criterion with no relevant response earns 0.